

Next.js 15 Handbook

This handbook provides a concise overview of important concepts in Next.js 15.

App Router

The App Router is the recommended routing system. Routes are created using folders inside the app directory. Layouts allow shared UI, while nested routes make it easy to build complex applications.

Server Components

Server Components render on the server by default, reducing client-side JavaScript and improving performance. Use the 'use client' directive only when browser APIs or React hooks like useState are required.

Data Fetching

Data can be fetched directly inside Server Components using async/await. Next.js supports caching, revalidation, and dynamic rendering depending on your application's needs.

Routing

Special files include page.tsx for pages, layout.tsx for shared layouts, loading.tsx for loading UI, error.tsx for error boundaries, and not-found.tsx for custom 404 pages.

Server Actions

Server Actions let you execute server-side logic directly from forms and components without creating traditional API endpoints.

Performance Tips

Optimize images with the Image component, lazy load components when appropriate, minimize client components, and use route-level code splitting for faster page loads.